

LESSON

Review All the Tenses – *Dance, Think, Flirt, Remember* (intermediate B1–B2)

The song uses the same verbs – **dance, think, remember, flirt, feel** – in every tense. Each verse tells you **when** the action happens. Spanish and Portuguese have very similar tenses, but English uses some of them differently. This guide shows the form, the use, an example from the song, and the most common mistake for Spanish and Portuguese speakers.

Quick map: when is the action?

Time	Tense	Example
Every day / always	Present simple	I dance under the lights.
Finished past	Past simple	I danced all night.
In progress in the past	Past continuous	I was dancing slowly.
Life up to now	Present perfect	I have danced with you so many times.
Before another past moment	Past perfect	I had danced many times before.
Future	Future simple	I will dance with you again.
Imaginary	Conditional	I would dance with you all night.
Finished before a future time	Future perfect	I will have danced with many people.

The tenses in three languages

The same two verbs, **dance** and **think**, in every English tense, with Spanish and Portuguese side by side.

Tense	Function	English	Spanish	Portuguese
Present Simple	Dance	I dance	Yo bailo	Eu danço
	Think	I think	Yo pienso	Eu penso
Present Continuous	Dance	I am dancing	Estoy bailando	Estou dançando
	Think	I am thinking	Estoy pensando	Estou pensando
Present Perfect	Dance	I have danced	He bailado	Eu tenho dançado
	Think	I have thought	He pensado	Eu tenho pensado
Present Perfect Continuous	Dance	I have been dancing	He estado bailando	Tenho estado dançando
	Think	I have been thinking	He estado pensando	Tenho estado pensando
Past Simple	Dance	I danced	Yo bailé	Eu dancei
	Think	I thought	Yo pensé	Eu pensei
Past Continuous	Dance	I was dancing	Yo estaba bailando	Eu estava dançando
	Think	I was thinking	Yo estaba pensando	Eu estava pensando
Past Perfect	Dance	I had danced	Yo había bailado	Eu tinha dançado
	Think	I had thought	Yo había pensado	Eu tinha pensado
Past Perfect Continuous	Dance	I had been dancing	Yo había estado bailando	Eu tinha estado dançando
	Think	I had been thinking	Yo había estado pensando	Eu tinha estado pensando
Future Simple	Dance	I will dance	Yo bailaré	Eu vou dançar / dançarei
	Think	I will think	Yo pensaré	Eu vou pensar / pensarei
Future Continuous	Dance	I will be dancing	Estaré bailando	Estarei dançando
	Think	I will be thinking	Estaré pensando	Estarei pensando
Future Perfect	Dance	I will have danced	Habré bailado	Terei dançado
	Think	I will have thought	Habré pensado	Terei pensado
Future Perfect Continuous	Dance	I will have been dancing	Habré estado bailando	Terei estado dançando
	Think	I will have been thinking	Habré estado pensando	Terei estado pensando
Conditional Simple	Dance	I would dance	Yo bailaría	Eu dançaria
	Think	I would think	Yo pensaría	Eu pensaria
Conditional Continuous	Dance	I would be dancing	Estaría bailando	Eu estaria dançando
	Think	I would be thinking	Estaría pensando	Eu estaria pensando
Conditional Perfect	Dance	I would have danced	Yo habría bailado	Eu teria dançado
	Think	I would have thought	Yo habría pensado	Eu teria pensado
Conditional Perfect Continuous	Dance	I would have been dancing	Yo habría estado bailando	Eu teria estado dançando
	Think	I would have been thinking	Yo habría estado pensando	Eu teria estado pensando

Watch out: the table shows the closest form in each language, but the **use** is not always the same. For example, Portuguese *Eu tenho dançado* means you have been dancing again and again recently. For a single experience, Portuguese usually says *Eu já dancei*, but English still needs the present perfect: **I have danced**. See section 4.

Each tense, step by step

1. Present simple – every day

Form	I / you / we / they + verb · he / she / it + verb + s
Use it for	habits, routines, things that are always true
Signal words	every day, always, usually, often, never

In the song:

*I **dance** under the lights and **think** about you. You **dance** close to me and **remember**.*

ES: Yo bailo y pienso en ti. · PT: Eu danço e penso em ti.

More examples: She **dances** every Friday. He **thinks** about her all the time.

Watch out: don't forget the **-s** with he / she / it: *she dance* ✗ *she dances* ✓

2. Past simple – yesterday

Form	verb + -ed (regular) · irregular: think → thought , feel → felt
Use it for	a finished action at a finished time in the past
Signal words	yesterday, last night, last year, ago, in 2020

In the song:

*I **danced** all night and **thought** about how close you were to me. You **danced** with me and **remembered**...*

ES: Yo bailé... y pensé... · PT: Eu dancei... e pensei...

More examples: We **flirted** at the party last night. I **felt** nervous.

Watch out: the past of *think* is **thought**, not *thinked*.

3. Past continuous – in progress in the past

Form	was / were + verb-ing
Use it for	an action in progress at a moment in the past; the background to another action
Signal words	while, when, at that moment, all evening

In the song:

*I **was dancing** slowly while imagining that you would look at me like that again.*

ES: Yo bailaba lentamente... · PT: Eu dançava devagar...

More examples: I **was dancing** when you arrived. They **were flirting** all evening.

Watch out: Spanish *bailaba* / Portuguese *dançava* is sometimes past continuous (*was dancing*) and sometimes a habit (*used to dance*). Ask: was it in progress, or was it a habit?

4. Present perfect – my experience up to now

Form	have / has + past participle
Use it for	life experience, and past actions connected to now – the exact time is not important
Signal words	ever, never, already, yet, so many times, since, for

In the song:

*I **have danced** with you so many times that every song brings back your memory. You **have danced** with others, but you **have** always **flirted** thinking of me.*

ES: Yo he bailado contigo... · PT: Eu já dancei com você...

More examples: **Have** you ever **danced** salsa? She **has** never **felt** so happy.

Watch out: Portuguese often uses the simple past here (*Eu já dancei*), but English needs **have danced**. And never use it with a finished time: *I have danced yesterday* ✗

5. Past perfect – *before another past moment*

Form	had + past participle
Use it for	an action that happened before another action or time in the past
Signal words	before, by the time, already, never ... before

In the song:

*I **had danced** many times, but I **had never felt** such an electric flirtation.*

ES: Yo había bailado... · PT: Eu tinha dançado...

More examples: By the time you arrived, I **had** already **danced** three songs.

Watch out: use it only when you need to show which past action came **first**.

6. Future simple – *in the future*

Form	will + verb · also be going to + verb for plans
Use it for	predictions, promises and decisions about the future
Signal words	tomorrow, next week, again, one day, soon

In the song:

*I **will dance** with you again and **will feel** that same game of glances.*

ES: Yo bailaré... · PT: Eu vou dançar... / dançarei

More examples: I'll call you tomorrow. We're **going to** dance at the wedding.

Watch out: after *will*, use the base verb: *will dances* ✗ *will danced* ✗ *will dance* ✓

7. Conditional – *with hope*

Form	would + verb · If + past simple, would + verb
Use it for	imaginary situations and wishes (the second conditional)
Signal words	if, I wish, imagine

In the song:

*I **would dance** with you all night if you **asked** me.*

ES: Yo bailarías contigo si me lo pidieras. · PT: Eu dançaria com você se você me pedisse.

More examples: If I **were** braver, I **would flirt** with him.

Watch out: no *would* in the *if* part: *if you would ask me* ✗ *if you asked me* ✓

8. Future perfect – *finished before a future time*

Form	will have + past participle
Use it for	an action that will be finished before a time in the future
Signal words	by then, by next year, before

In the song:

*The Spanish and Portuguese lines at the end use this tense: Yo **habré bailado** con muchos antes de olvidarte. In English: I **will have danced** with many people before I forget you.*

ES: Yo habré bailado... · PT: Eu terei dançado...

More examples: By midnight, we **will have danced** for five hours.

Watch out: after *before*, use the present, not the future: *before I will forget you* ✗ *before I forget you* ✓

Irregular verbs in the song

Learn the three forms together: **base – past simple – past participle**.

Base	Past simple	Past participle	Example
think	thought	thought	I have thought about you every day.
feel	felt	felt	I had never felt like this.
bring	brought	brought	Every song brought back your memory.
be	was / were	been	You were so close to me.
dance (regular)	danced	danced	We danced all night.
remember (regular)	remembered	remembered	You remembered that moment.
flirt (regular)	flirted	flirted	They have flirted for weeks.

Practice – choose the tense

Write the verb in brackets in the correct tense. Look for the signal words.

- Every Saturday, we _____ (dance) at the same club.
- Last night I _____ (think) about you until 3 a.m.
- I _____ (dance) when the music suddenly stopped.
- _____ you ever _____ (flirt) with someone in a different language?
- Before I met you, I _____ never _____ (feel) so nervous.
- Next summer we _____ (dance) on the beach in Rio.
- If you _____ (ask) me, I _____ (dance) with you all night.
- By the end of the year, I _____ (learn) all the English tenses!

Answers: 1 dance · 2 thought · 3 was dancing · 4 Have ... flirted · 5 had ... felt · 6 will dance / are going to dance · 7 asked, would dance · 8 will have learned / learnt

Talk about it

- Which English tense is the most difficult for you? Why?
- Tell a partner about a time you danced: when? where? who with? (past simple)
- Have you ever learned a song in another language? (present perfect)
- Where will you be dancing next year? What would you do if you could dance with anyone? (future, conditional)